

GRAMMAR

Grammar is a set of rules that governs the structure of expression in English language. It can be define also, as rules governing the combination of words into meaningful sentence in English language. Grammar is also a set of rules that governs the use of a particular language.

PARTS OF SPEECH

Below are the basic parts of speech:

- i. Noun
- ii. Pronoun
- iii. Verb
- iv. Adjective
- v. Adverb
- vi. Preposition
- vii. Conjunction
- viii. Interjection

Noun - Noun is a word used to name a person, thing, an idea or a quality of mind, an animal or place.

Examples

1. Africa is a Continent
2. I need a book to supplement my knowledge.
3. The bread is ready for eating.

Pronoun - A pronoun is a word that can take the place of a noun in order to avoid repetition.

Examples:

- i. Joy is my friend. She is very beautiful.
2. I visited Ataya. This is the capital of Alg.
3. Ibrahim misplaced the money. He could not find it.

Verb - A word used to express action,

Condition or existence.

Examples

1. I waited for James.
2. She is healthy.

ADJECTIVE - Adjectives are words which describe or qualify a noun.

Examples

1. Amina is a beautiful girl
2. The smart young boy deceived her
3. She is a brilliant student

ADVERB - A word used to modify a verb, an adjective or another adverb.

Examples

1. Princess is very beautiful.
The word 'very' modifies the adjective beautiful.

2. They lived happily.
The word 'happily' modifies the verb lived.

PREPOSITION - A preposition is a word which shows the relationship between two words in a sentence.

Examples

1. I deposited my money in the bank
2. I am fond of mango
3. She is angry with me

CONJUNCTION - A conjunction is a word which joins or links words, phrases or sentences together.

Examples

1. He tried hard but he failed in his attempt.
2. I came, I saw and I conquered.
3. I visited Jos and Abuja last year.

INTERJECTION - Interjections are words that we use to express sudden feelings or emotion such as surprise, pleasure, pain and disappointment. They usually go with exclamation mark (!) as an indicator.

Examples

1. Alas! trouble has erupted again.
2. Dead! who then will pay my school fees?
3. What a pity! She couldn't make credit in the paper.

PUNCTUATION MARKS

Punctuations the right use 'stops' in a sentence. Below are examples of some punctuation marks.

- | | |
|--------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Full stop [.] | 4. Colon [:] |
| 2. Comma [,] | 5. Exclamation mark [!] |
| 3. Semicolon [;] | 6. Question mark [?] |
| 7. Question | 7. Quotation mark [" "] |
| 9. Hyphen [-] | 8. Bracket [()] |
| 10. Karet [^] | 12. Apostrophe ['] |
| 11. Ellipsis [...] | |

FULL STOP [.] - It marks the longest pause. It is used at the end of every declarative or imperative sentence. And also after initials & please come here.

2. Man is a social animal.
3. The U.S.A

COMMA [,] - It marks the shortest pause. It is used to separate three or more words

of the same parts of speech. Ex.

1. Noun: I saw Mary, John, Mary and Hassan.
2. Verb - I wrote, read, examined and put aside the document.
3. Adjective - Temimah is beautiful, attractive, rich and polite.

SEMICOLON (;) - is used to ~~se~~ separate sentences which are closely connected in thoughts. Ex.

1. AS he was fortunate, I rejoice at it;
2. AS John loved me, I weep for him;

- COLON (:)** - It is used to introduce a quotation.
1. John Keats Says: A thing of Beauty is a joy forever
 2. Aristotle said: Man is a social animal.

- (*) TO** Introduce a list
1. The subjects I like: English, music, government and Biology.

- (*) TO** Introduce an explanation, a statement or a proposition. Ex.
1. The reason for my delay in this: I did not get up early today.

EXCLAMATION MARK (!) - It is used at the end of an exclamatory sentence and interjections expressing some sudden emotion - Ex.

1. What a great victory!
2. What a beauty!
3. It may also be used as a short order. Ex.
 1. Come here!
 2. Wait!
 3. Shut up!

QUESTION MARK [?] - It is used after a direct question. ex.

1. What are you doing here?
2. What is your name?
3. Did you post the letter?

QUOTATION MARK [' '] - It is used to enclose the title of books, articles, poems, play etc. ex.

- a. Do you like 'Tales of moonlight'.
- b. You must have read 'Animal Kingdom'.

It is also used to enclose words and punctuation in direct speech. ex.

- a. 'What did you do that for?' he asked.

KARET [^] - It indicates an omission in written work. Example

a. 'In the animal kingdom, cats and dogs are worst of enemies'.

Below is an example of a passage with the use of punctuation.

Marriage as a human institution is facing threat in the twentieth century. Never, since the first man and woman were joined together, has the institution of marriage been beset by as many problems as it is now. And the trend, which started in the western world, has spread and is spreading to all parts of the globe.

From the passage above, you can see how punctuation marks are used.

IDIOMS

Every language has its own idioms and they are an integral part of the language. They add beauty and charm to the language. Examples of English idioms are below:

1. A bed of roses — A very comfortable and pleasant condition.
2. An apple of ones eye — Very dear.
3. A black sheep — An evil person.
4. Hush Money — Bribe.
5. Point black — Directly.
6. Crocodile tears — False tears.
7. A man of letters — A great literary artist.
8. A chicken hearted fellow — A cowardly person.
9. A cock and bull story — A false story.
~~10. A big gun~~ — A person of great importance.
 — You can use all these idioms in a sentence.
1. Accountancy is not a bed of roses.
2. He should be aware of black sheep in society.
3. He got a job by paying hush money.
4. When Muns died, his wife shed crocodile tears.
5. Achebe is a man of letters.
6. My friend is a chicken hearted fellow.
7. Amina tried to convince me by telling me a cock and bull story.

FIGURES OF SPEECH

A figure of speech is a word or expression that is used in a different way other than the normal one in order to give you a picture in your mind. It is a device used by a speaker or a writer to make his/her message more vividly. The figures of speech includes the following.

1. **PERSONIFICATION** - This refers to situations whereby human attributes or qualities are given to non-humans. Examples

- The flowers danced when the wind blew.
- The sun smiled at me.
- Night has come and spread her blanket.

2. **METAPHOR** - This figure of speech compares two things or persons directly. Examples

- Musa is a lion in the battle.
- Life is a walking shadow.
- Emeka is a loko tree.

3. **SIMILE** - This figure of speech is used to compare two persons or things indirectly by using "as" or "like". Examples

- Musa is like a lion in the battle.
- Life is like a walking shadow.
- Emeka is as tall as an loko tree.

4. **HYPERBOLE** - This figure of speech is an exaggeration used deliberately to express feelings that promote things or person to higher levels than their actual levels.

Examples

- a. I have the power to move mountains
- b. I feel on top of the world
- c. Peter ate a mountain of eggs

5 IRONY - This is a figure of speech that conveys an opposite meaning to the literal meaning of an utterance. Examples.

- a. Chimpanzee what a beautiful animal
- b. The dove is a violent bird
- c.

6 EUPHEMISM - This refers to using a statement in less offensive way, especially when it appears offensive to the hearer or reader. Examples

- a. He came across the men of the under world.
- b. She is a commercial sex worker.
- c.

7. PARADOX - This figure of speech hides its meaning by presenting ideas that appear to be unreasonable. Examples

- a. The child is the father of the man
- b. The egg is the chicken

8 ALLITERATION - This figure of speech is the repetition of consonant sounds usually at the beginning of words. Examples

- a. Father Francis fried five fish for Friday
- b. Some stupid students smoke